

THE ARTISANAL LENS

A Guided Photography App for Handloom Artisans

Solution Design: Category-First Flow, Guided Presets & Photography Techniques

The App Concept

A Camera guide that thinks like a photographer, so the Artisan doesn't have to



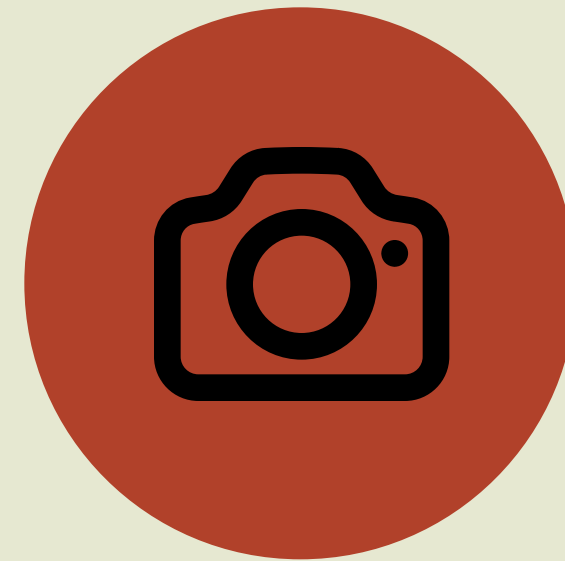
Category- First

The Artisan picks their product type first- every guide that follows is tailored to it



Preset Driven

Fold styles and shot techniques are pre-built presets, not decisions the Artisan has to make alone.



Guided- Capture

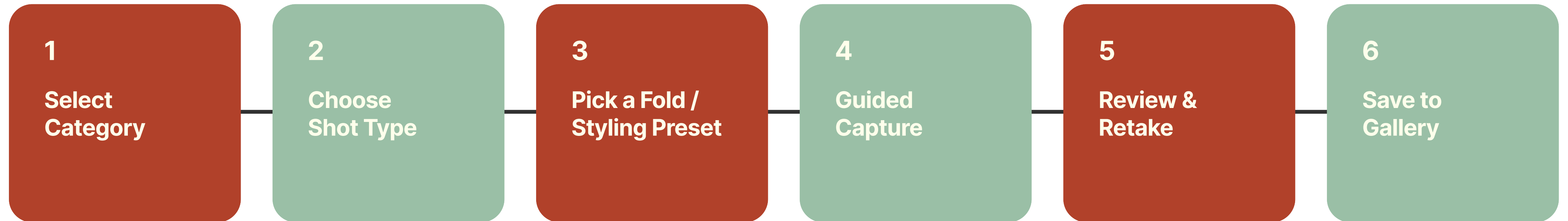
Live on-screen overlays for angle, framing and light — Artisans match the guide, then shoot.



Complete sets

The app tracks which shots (process, product, detail, lifestyle) are done and which remain.

User Flow



Onboarding asks only what's needed to tailor the guide — product category and, on repeat use, preferred language

Everything past step 1 automatically comes around the chosen category — different folds, different angle guides, different lighting tips

Step 1 - Category Selection

The first screen the artisan sees. One tap sets up everything downstream.

Why Category first?

Different drape, different rules

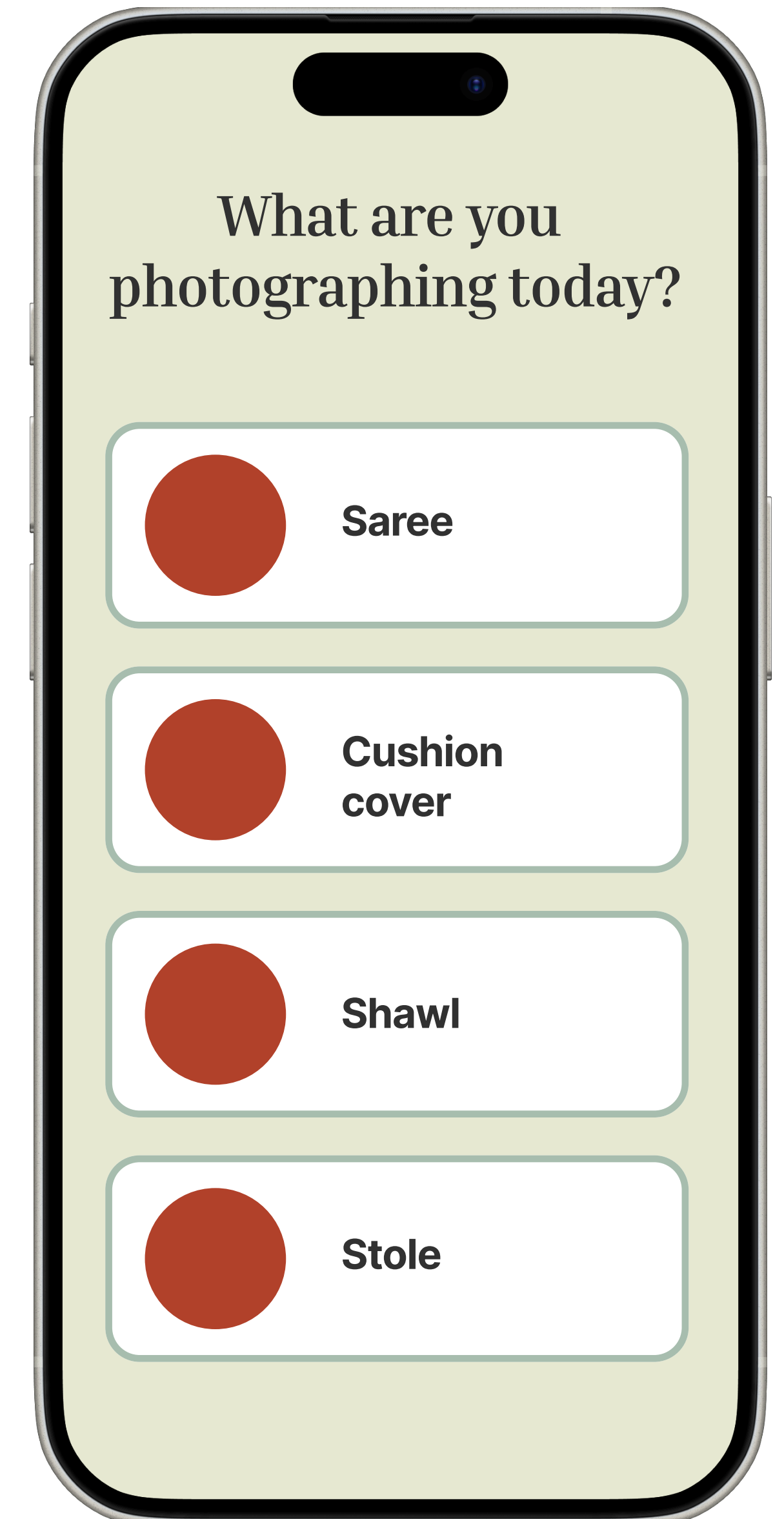
A saree pallu, a folded cushion cover, a draped shawl and a laid-flat stole each need their own angle and framing logic — one generic guide would fit none of them well.

Shorter guide sequences

Instead of one long universal tutorial, each category loads only the presets relevant to it — fewer screens, faster capture.

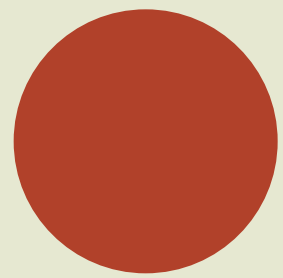
Presets can be product-specific

Fold styles, hero-shot angles and even lighting suggestions can be pre-built per category and expanded later (e.g. dupattas, bedsheets) without reworking the whole app.



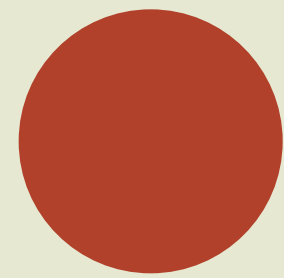
Fold & Styling Presets

Each fold preset pairs automatically with a matching angle, lighting and composition combination



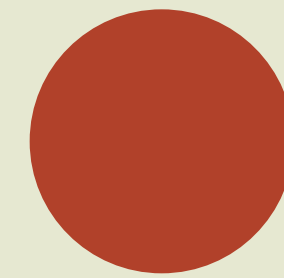
Saree

- Pallu drape (hanger)
- Box / flat fold
- Worn drape (model)
- Roll display



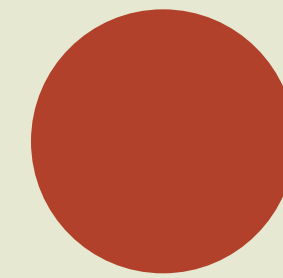
Cushion Cover

- Flat lay
- Stacked pair
- Propped on seating
- Corner tuck close-up



Shawl

- Draped on shoulder
- Folded stack
- Hung / pinned flat
- Corner tuck close-up

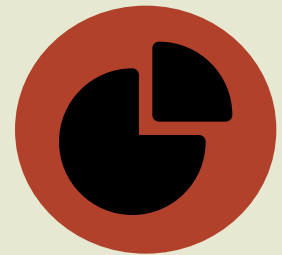


Stole

- Neck wrap (worn)
- Flat spread
- Loose knot
- Rolled coil

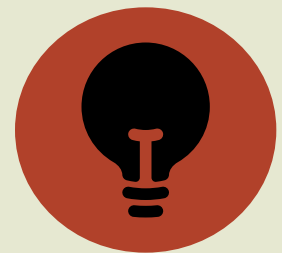
Photography Technique Presets

The first screen the artisan sees. One tap sets up everything downstream.



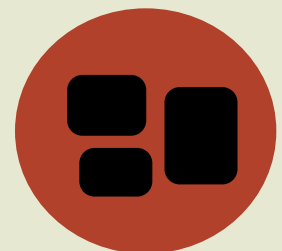
Angle

Eye-level · Overhead (flat lay) · Low angle · Macro close-up



Lighting

Soft window light · Diffused daylight · Avoid harsh midday sun · Backlight for sheer fabrics



Composition

Rule of thirds · Centered product · Negative space around folds · Leading fabric lines



Shot Type

Process · Product · Detail (texture/weave) · Lifestyle (worn/styled)

The Guided Capture Screen

The first screen the artisan sees. One tap sets up everything downstream.

What the overlay does

Ghost frame guide

A saree pallu, a folded cushion cover, a draped shawl and a laid-flat stole each need their own angle and framing logic — one generic guide would fit none of them well.

Live light check

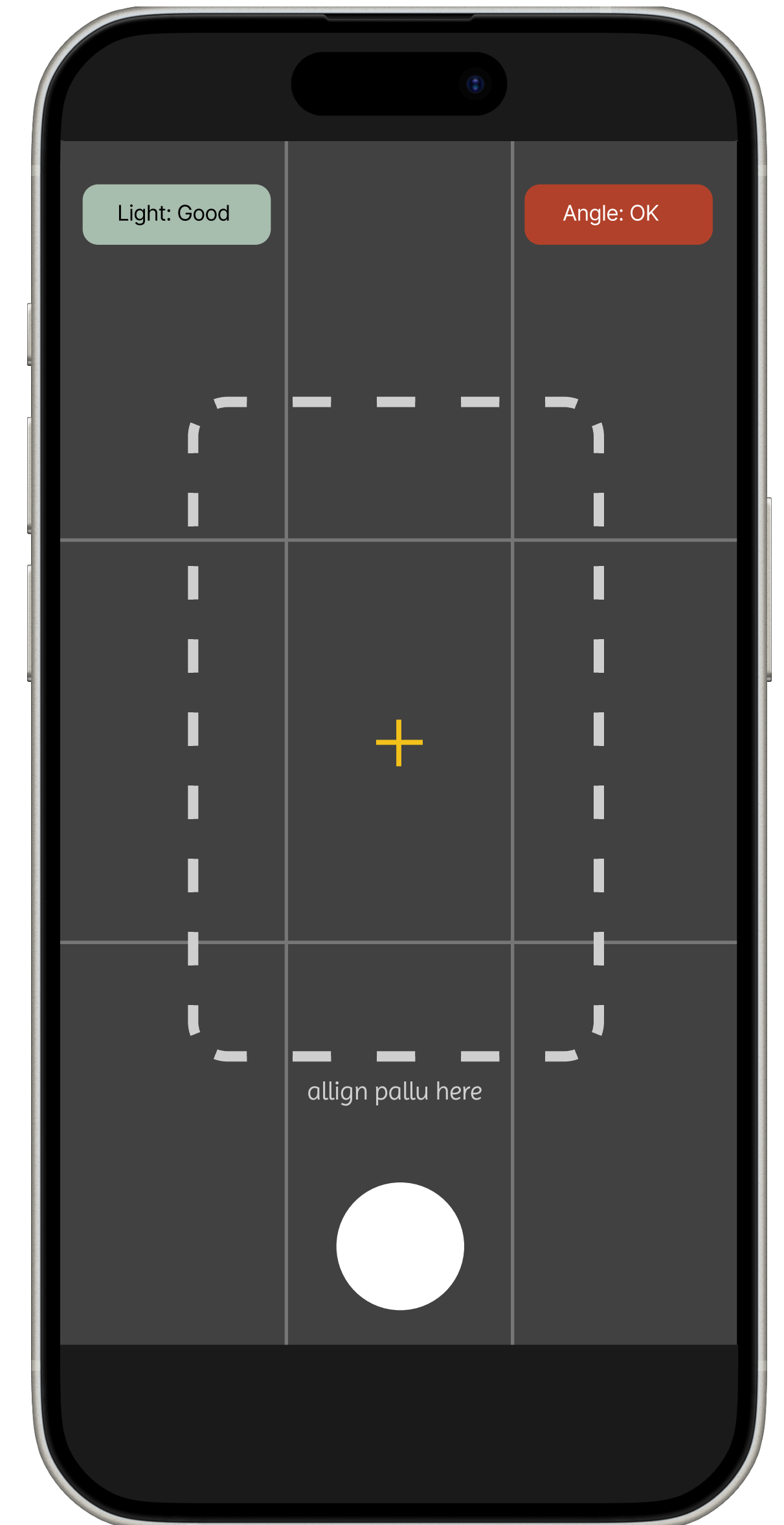
Instead of one long universal tutorial, each category loads only the presets relevant to it — fewer screens, faster capture.

Angle & level indicator

Fold styles, hero-shot angles and even lighting suggestions can be pre-built per category and expanded later (e.g. dupattas, bedsheets) without reworking the whole app.

Grid overlay

Fold styles, hero-shot angles and even lighting suggestions can be pre-built per category and expanded later (e.g. dupattas, bedsheets) without reworking the whole app.

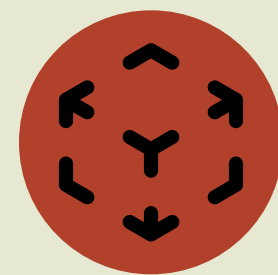


Core App Features



Category & Preset Library

Saree, Cushion Cover, Shawl, Stole — each with its own fold and shot-type presets, expandable over time.



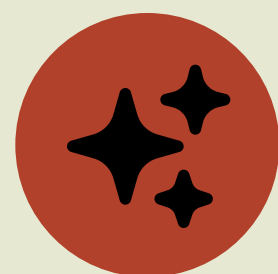
Live Guided Capture

Ghost-frame overlay, angle indicator and lighting check, all tied to the chosen preset.



Shot Checklist

Tracks Process / Product / Detail / Lifestyle shots per item so nothing is missed before publishing.



Auto Tips

Short, contextual nudges ("move closer to the window") instead of long tutorials.



Review & Retake

Side-by-side comparison against the reference preset before saving, so a bad shot is caught immediately.



Vernacular & Icon-first UI

Local language support and icon-led navigation for low digital-literacy users

Sample Flow — Photographing a Saree

1. Category	Artisan selects "Saree" on the home screen.
2. Shot type	Chooses "Product shot" from Process / Product / Detail / Lifestyle
3. Fold preset	Picks "Pallu drape (hanger)" from the preset list.
4. Auto setup	App loads eye-level angle, soft-light tip, and rule-of-thirds grid
5. Guided capture	Ghost frame shows where to hang the pallu; light/angle chips confirm readiness.
6. Review	Shot is compared to the reference thumbnail; retake or accept
7. Checklist	App marks "Product — Saree" as done, prompts for the next required shot type

Designing for the Artisan, Not the App

These considerations come directly from the research findings on digital literacy and language barriers



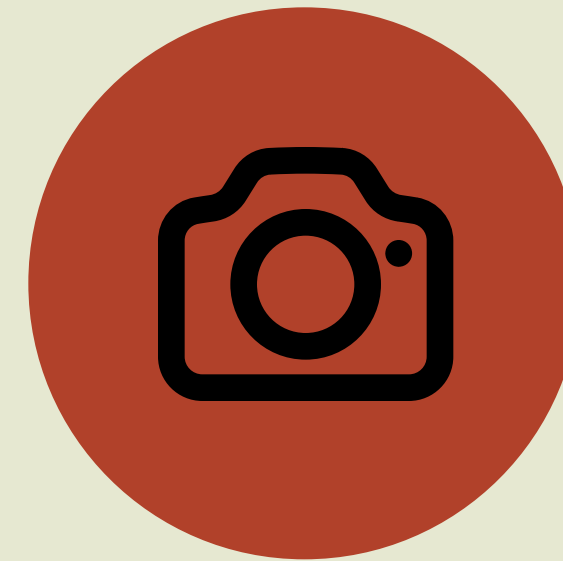
Vernacular language

Regional language and voice-guided prompts, addressing the 42% who cite language barriers.



Icon-first navigation

Minimal text, large tap targets, and visual presets over dropdown menus or settings screens



One decision at a time

Category → shot type → preset, never more than one choice per screen, to reduce cognitive load.



Works offline

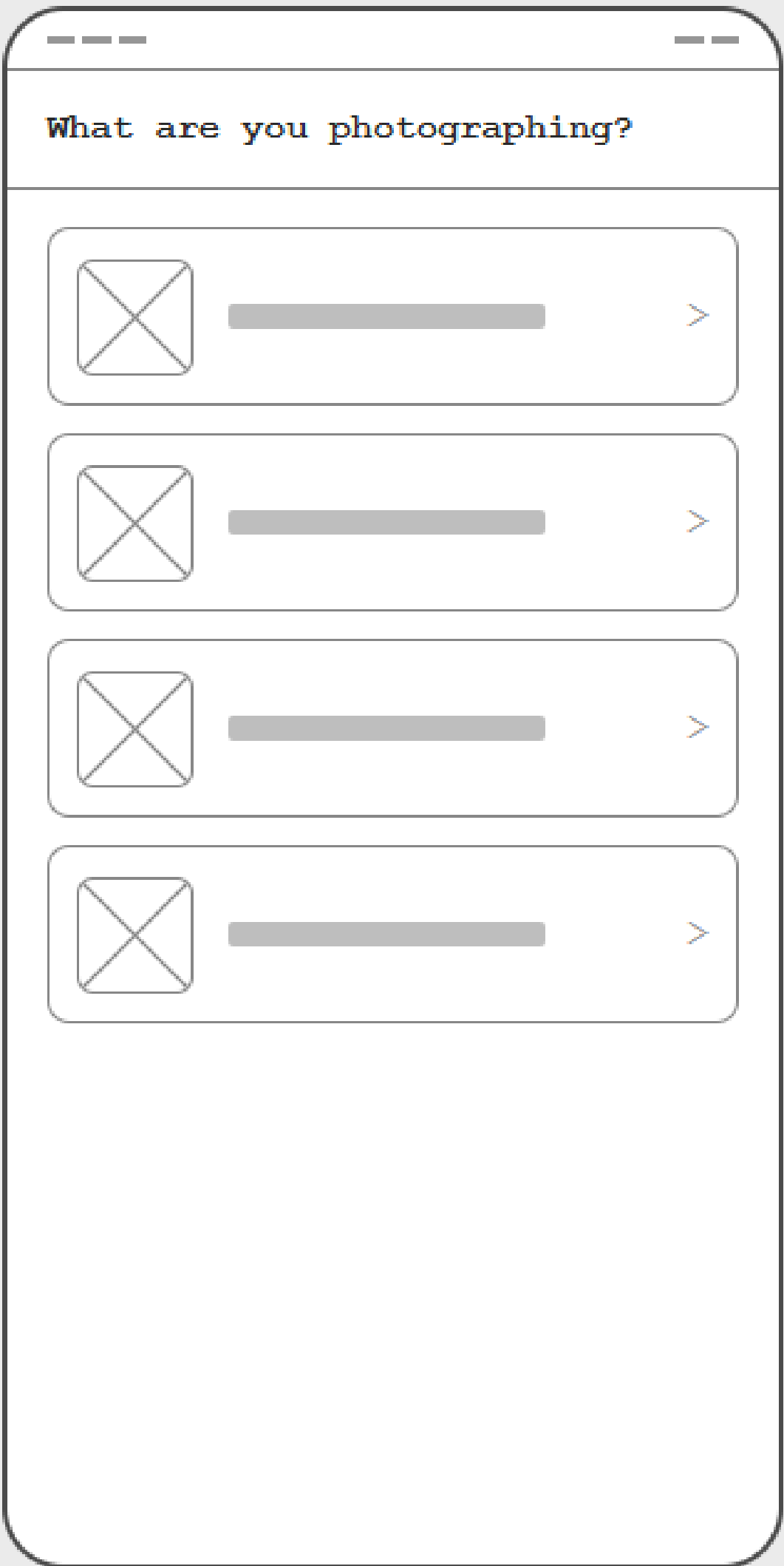
Guides and overlays run locally on-device; photos sync when connectivity is available.

Low Fidelity Wireframes for the App

THE ARTISANAL LENS — LOW-FIDELITY WIREFRAMES

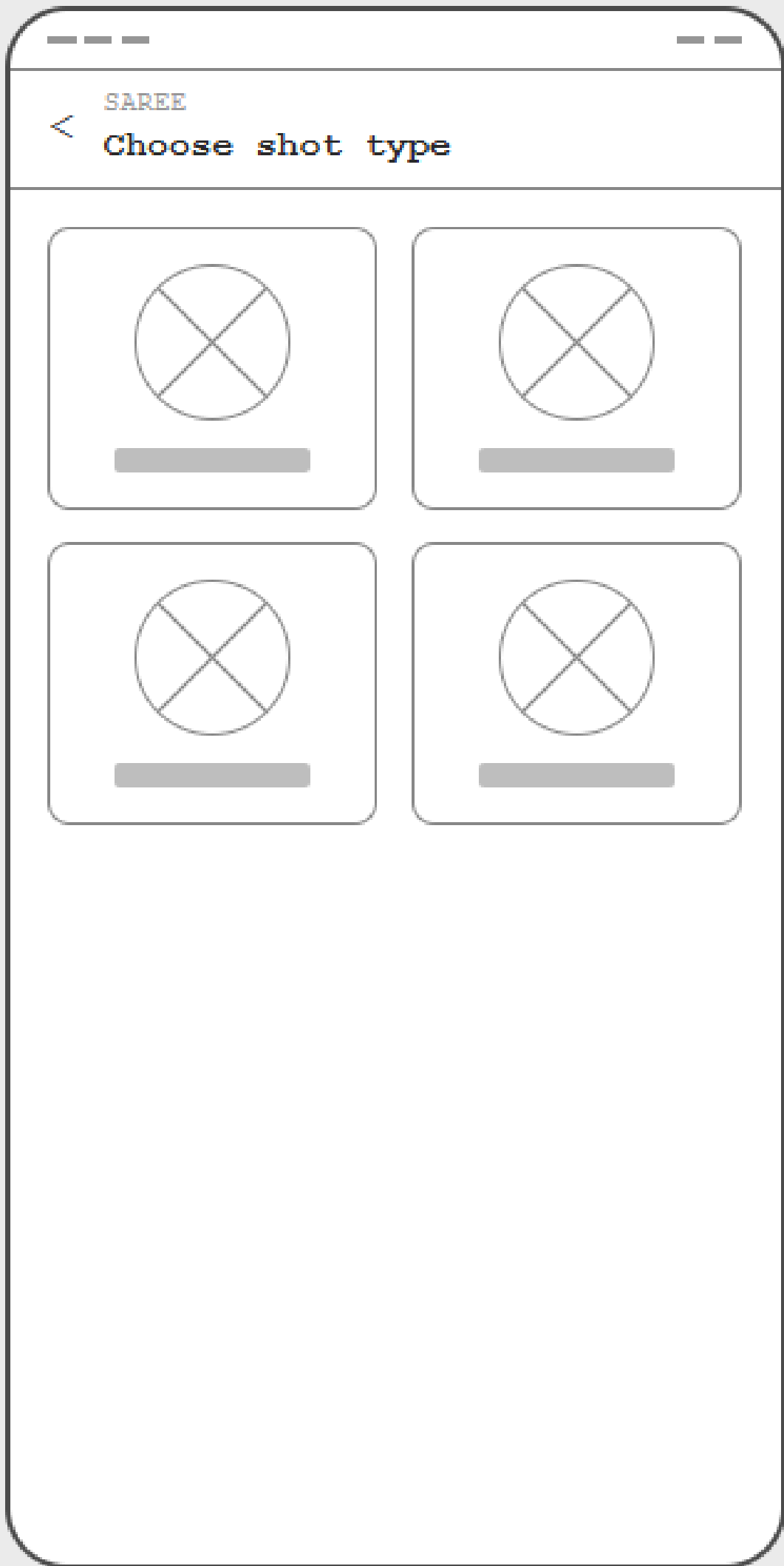
Six core screens, in sequence · placeholder content only · not final visual design

1 CATEGORY SELECTION



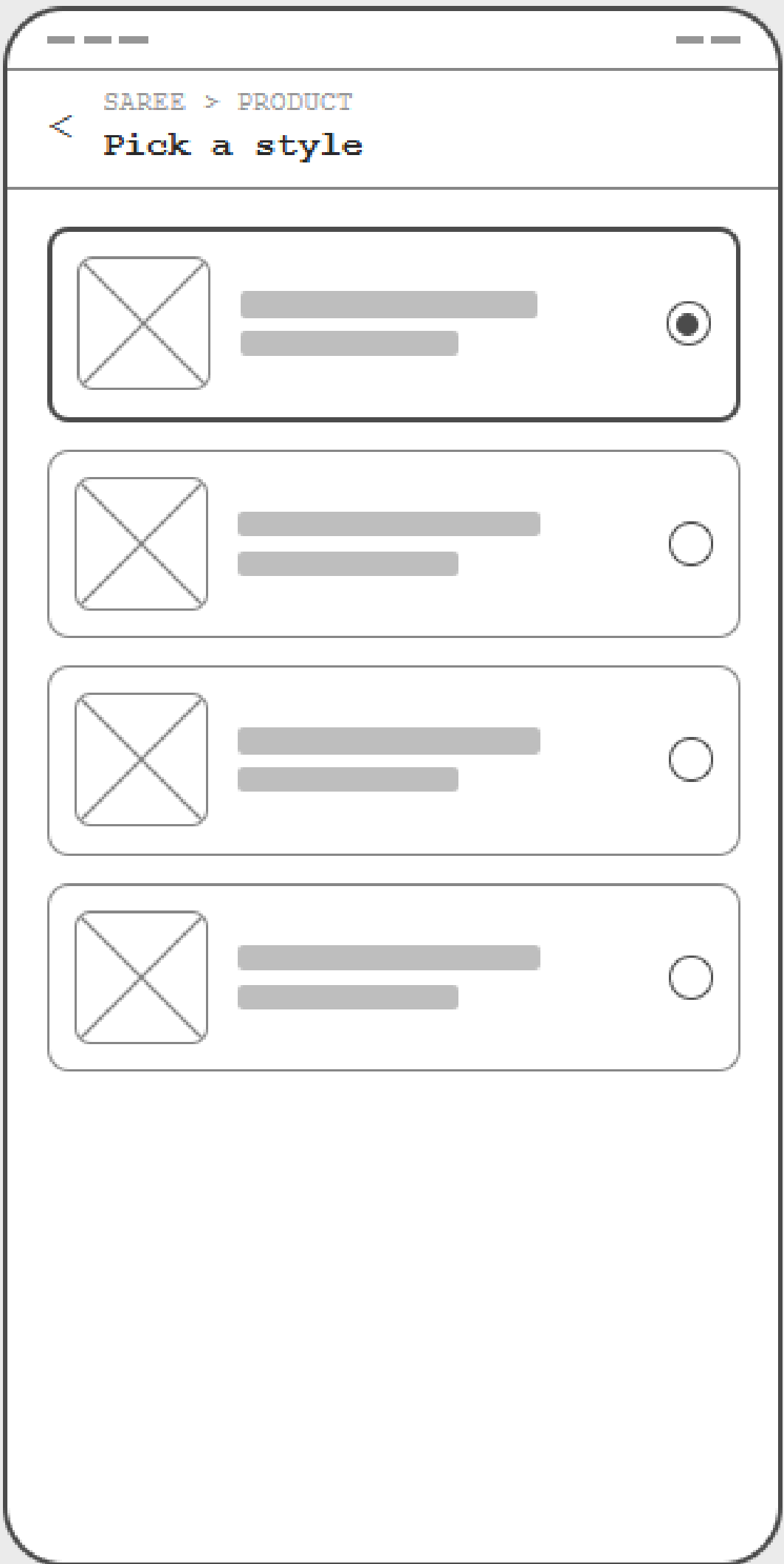
Saree / Cushion Cover / Shawl / Stole. One tap sets category for every screen after this.

2 SHOT TYPE



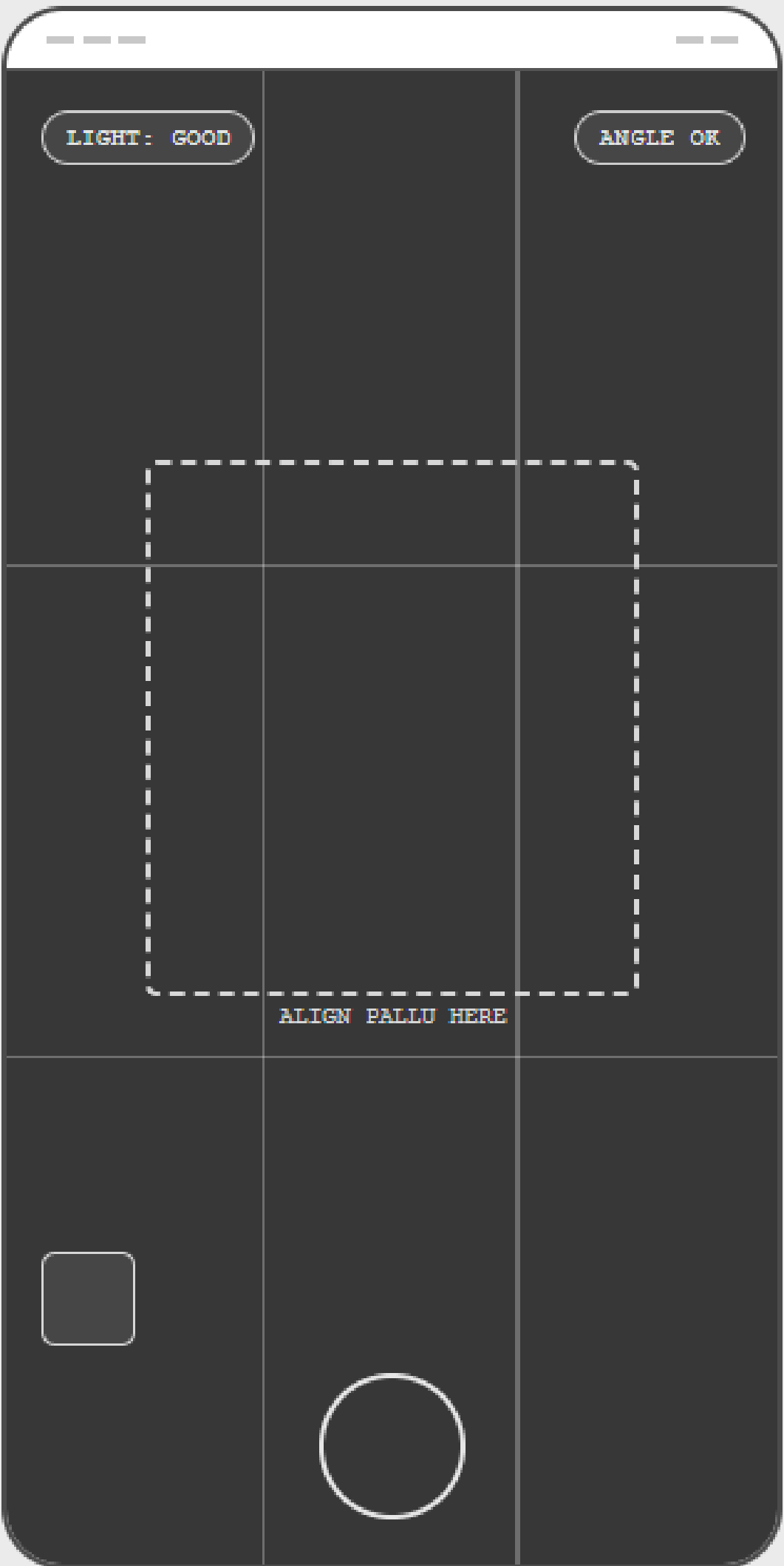
Process / Product / Detail / Lifestyle. Skips fold guidance entirely for Detail shots.

3 FOLD / STYLE PRESET



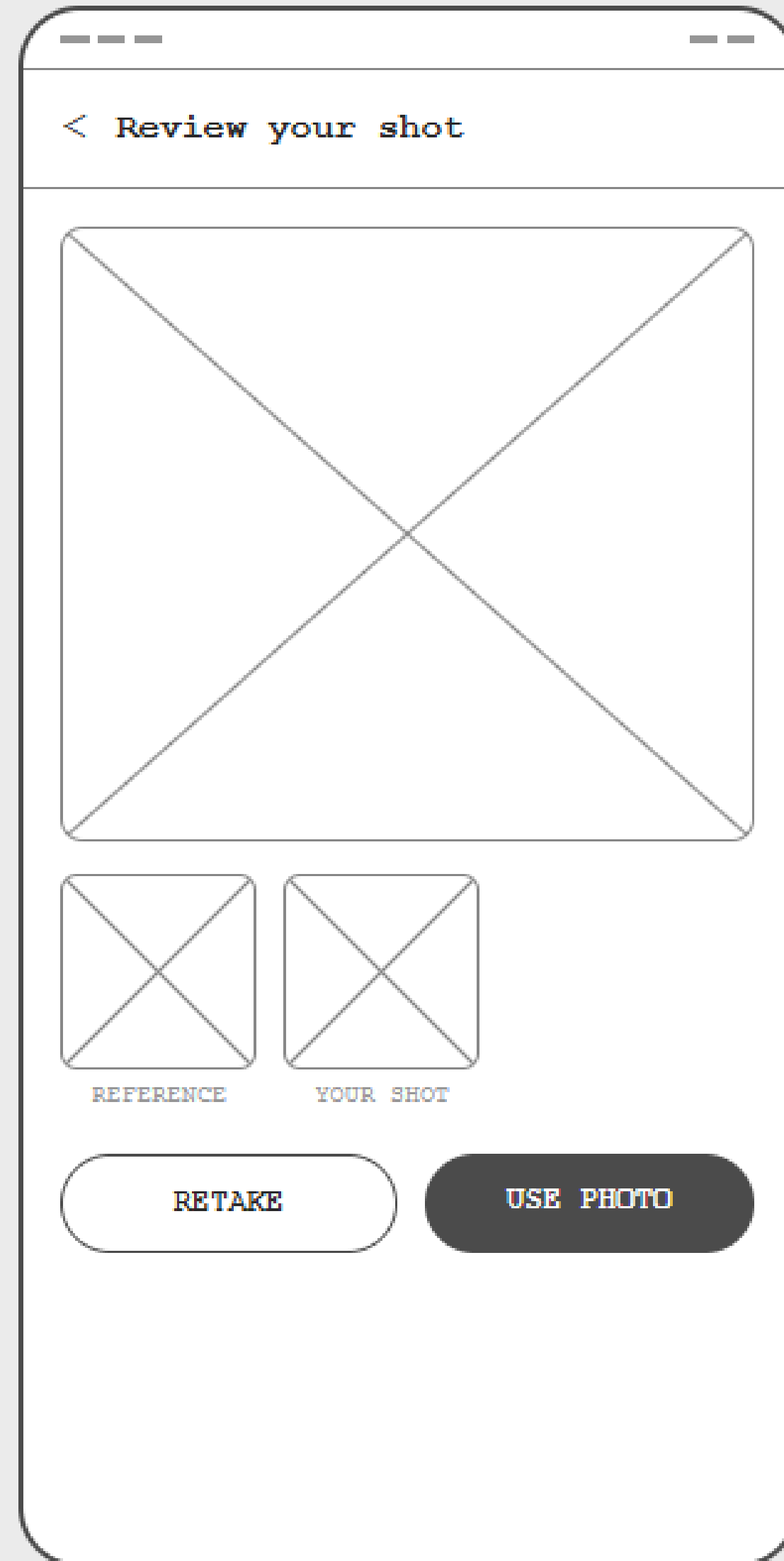
e.g. Pallu drape / Box fold / Worn drape / Roll display. Selecting one auto-loads its angle + light preset.

4 GUIDED CAPTURE



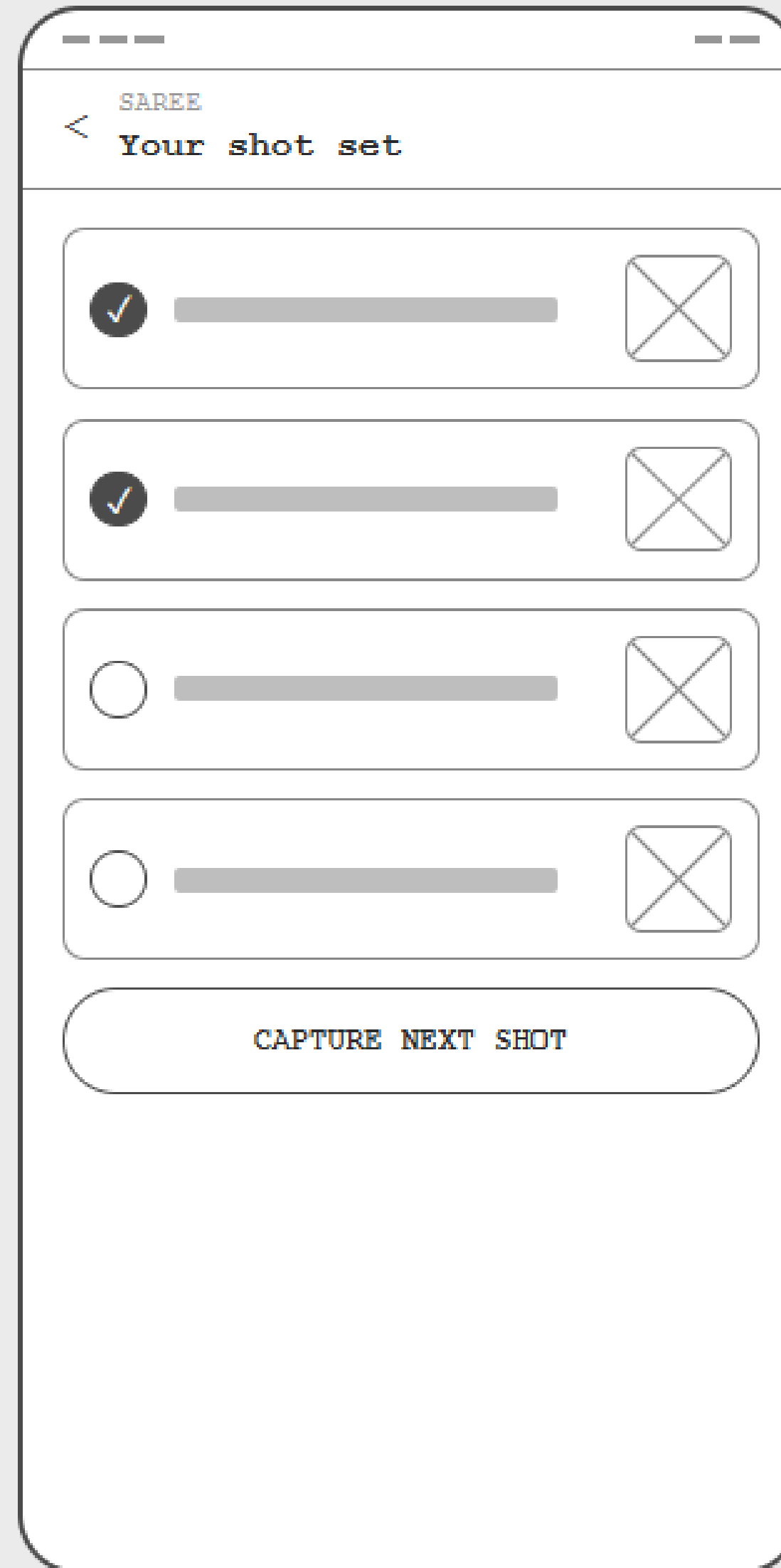
Live camera + dashed ghost-frame + light/angle chips + small reference thumbnail (bottom-left).

5 REVIEW & RETAKE



Reference preset thumbnail next to the new shot, so a mismatch is obvious before saving.

6 SHOT CHECKLIST



Tracks Process / Product / Detail / Lifestyle per item – nothing gets published half-finished.